

Pet Supply Store Project

1. The Scope

I have limited my mini world to just the shop portion which is what customers browse and buy in pet supply stores. I am not including other services such as vet care, training, or grooming since these are not things you purchase or they're things you make appointments for and have to be there physically. So in summary the scope of my project includes products which also include some live animals and not in-store or at-home services.

2. Research and findings

For my research I looked up multiple pet stores both large like Petco, PetSmart, and Chewy and smaller pet stores that are local to me like Pet Pantry Warehouse, Pawz On Top Pet Store and Choice Pet. I compared how each organizes their website stores and used what the majority had in common. Most shops have their websites organized by first Pet types and then they have subgroups underneath them for products. The following are the main groups I found-

Pet Type - Dog, Cat, Fish, Bird, reptile, small pet, and farm animals

Pet subtypes (some pet sections are broken down more)

ex. Small animals - Hamster & Gerbil Guinea Pig Rabbit Ferret Chinchilla Rat & Mouse
Hedgehog & Sugar Glider

Product groups - Food/care, Enclosures, Accessories, Live animals

These stores also made you log in and collect the following (name of customer, location of the customer, What pet and how many pets a customer has)

3. Requirements

Like in chapter 3 I split the requirements into data requirements (DR) which is what the database stores and functional requirements (FR) which is what users can do.

DR1 - Store the pet types the shop is organized by: Dog, Cat, Fish, Bird, Reptile, Small Pet, Farm

DR2 - Store subtypes for pet types that have them (ex., Small Pet: gerbil, hamster, mouse, rabbit)

DR3 - Store the product groups: Food/Care, Enclosures, Accessories, Live animals

DR4 - Each product is linked to the pet type (or subtype) it's for and the product group it's in

DR5 - Live animals are stored as their own kind of product, and not every pet type offers them

DR6 - store each customer's name and their location

DR7 - Store the pets each customer has and how many

FR1 - Browse products by pet type

FR2 - Narrow a pet type down by subtype

FR3 - Browse by product group within a pet type or the subtype